Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Learn With PsycLearn Essentials

Module 2
Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 1: Culture and Mood Disorders

- Focus of the Course
  Reading • 2 min
- Classifying Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- Culture and Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- Culture and Intersectionality
  Reading • 4 min
- Culture and Stigma
  Reading • 4 min
- Check Your Understanding: Culture and Mood Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Lesson 2: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

- Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Video • 6 min
- Living with a Mood Disorder: A Case Study
  Reading • 10 min
- Overview of Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min
- Check Your Understanding: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%

Key Takeaways

- Key Takeaways: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2 Quiz

- Module Quiz: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • Grade: 87.5%

Module 3
Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 3: Overview of Depressive Disorders

- Depression: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- What Does Depression Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Depressive Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- Check Your Understanding: Overview of Depressive Disorders
  Practice Assignment • 12 min

Lesson 4: Overview of Bipolar Disorders

- Bipolar: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- What Does Bipolar Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- Check Your Understanding: Overview of Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Key Takeaways

- Key Takeaways: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3 Quiz

- Module Quiz: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • Grade: 87.5%

Module 4
Biological Contributing Factors

Lesson 5: Genetic Contributing Factors

- **Developmental Psychopathology**
  Reading • 3 min
- Genetic Contributing Factors
  Reading • 3 min
- The Link Between Genes and Psychopathology
  Video • 4 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Genetic Contributing Factors for Depression
  Reading • 10 min
- Epigenetic Contributors to Depression
  Video • 3 min
- Genetic Contributing Factors for Bipolar Disorder
  Reading • 3 min
- Check Your Understanding: Genetic Contributing Factors
  Practice Assignment • 4 min

Lesson 6: Neurobiological Contributing Factors

- Depressive Disorders: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- Communication in the Synapse
  Video • 4 min
- Neurochemical Contributors to Depression
  Reading • 10 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Hormonal Contributors to Depression
  Reading • 5 min
- Brain Regions Linked to Depression
  Video • 4 min
- Neurobiological Contributors to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 15 min
- Check Your Understanding: Biological Contributing Factors
  Practice Assignment • 6 min

Key Takeaways

- Key Takeaways: Biological Contributing Factors
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4 Quiz

- Module Quiz: Biological Contributing Factors
  Graded Assignment • 9 min

Module 5
Psychological Contributing Factors

Module 6
Treatments for Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Module 7
Suicide

Module 8
Conclusion

Module 9
Cumulative Quiz

Module 10
Course Resources

Module 11
PsycLearn Essentials APA Student Resources

Developmental Psychopathology

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There is an interplay among the biological or psychological factors that influence depressive and bipolar disorders. Contemporary researchers and clinicians use a **developmental psychopathology** approach to explain psychological disorders (Cicchetti, 2013). The developmental psychopathology approach examines the origins and progression of psychological disorders using a developmental framework, meaning that it focuses on the typical processes of human growth and maturation. Development is an ongoing process that unfolds over an individual's lifespan. Every stage of our lives, from birth (and even the prenatal period) to the end of life, is part of the developmental process. As such, at every stage we experience biological, social, cognitive, emotional, and psychological challenges. These challenges—and how we address them—contribute to our ongoing psychological development.

Developmental psychopathologists believe it is important to consider all these factors in explaining behavior; no single factor in isolation is responsible for causing psychological disorders. Further, any explanation that considers only one factor will be incomplete (Cicchetti, 2013; Cicchetti & Rogosch, 1996). These beliefs lead to two key principles that underlie the developmental psychopathology approach. Equifinality describes how different experiences over the lifespan can contribute to the development of the same outcome, in this case a specific psychological disorder (Almy & Cicchetti, 2018). With equifinality, the same psychological disorder can be traced to a variety of factors for different individuals. Multifinality describes the phenomenon that occurs when individuals who experience similar factors during development end up with different outcomes. The presence of a particular factor during development does not necessarily lead to the same outcome for every individual.

The developmental psychopathology approach recognizes that multiple factors are at play when attempting to understand how psychological disorders develop. We can examine biological factors, such as genetics, neural activity, hormone or neurochemical levels, or broader environmental factors such as social and cultural influences. We can also examine psychological factors, such as cognitive distortions, level of stress, and ruminating behaviors. Clearly, these factors interact with each other, and ultimately play a role in the development of psychological disorders (Cicchetti & Valentino, 2007).

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